
Pongal


Deepavali


Christmas


Onam


Miladi Nabi


Buddha Poornima

2.4 Linguistic Diversity

According to census of India 2001, India has 122 major languages and 1599 other languages. Four major Indian language families are Indo-Aryan, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Sino Tibetian. Tamil is the oldest Dravidian language.

Top Five languages spoken in India (as per 2011 Census)	
Language	Percentage of total population
Hindi	43.63 %
Bengali	8.30 %
Telugu	6.93 %
Marathi	7.09 %
Tamil	5.89 %

Historically, the Portuguese, the Dutch, the British, the Danish and the French came to India for trade and their occupation of India or some parts of it has left behind a certain impact upon the culture and language of the people. Because the British ruled over the entire country for over three hundred years before independence in 1947, the English language gained prominence in India. In due course, English has emerged as an important language and a medium of instruction in schools and colleges. It is widely used in official communication and daily life.



The Constitution of India recognises twenty-two languages as official languages. The Government of India has declared Tamil as the first classical language in 2004. Apart from Tamil, five other Indian languages have been declared as the classical languages, by the Goverment of India. Sankrit, Telugu, Kannada, Malayalam, Oriya were announced as classical language in 2005, 2008, 2008 2013, 2016 respectively.

2.5 Cultural Diversity

The term 'culture' refers to customs and practices of people, their language, their dress code, cuisine, religion, social habits, music, art and architecture.

CIVICS TN_Govt_VI_Std_Ch 01.indd 196 23/12/2021 12:01:24